

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with direct experience in client-facing legal advice, client intake interviews and case file management at Citizens Advice, BCLP and Q-Legal. Practised at taking detailed factual accounts from clients across sensitive matters, identifying legal issues quickly, and communicating clearly with people who are distressed or unfamiliar with legal processes. Experienced in managing high volumes of enquiries, maintaining organised case records and meeting deadlines across concurrent matters. Strong written and verbal communication skills with a background in disputes and case preparation.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- First point of contact for clients across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; conducts detailed intake interviews, takes factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Assesses clients' situations against statutory and regulatory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex legal points
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals, including those who are distressed or unfamiliar with legal processes
- Manages matters from instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Liaised directly with the client to obtain required documents and coordinated with external translators, ensuring accurate information was gathered and passed through to the team
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions when the team was working to a significant procedural deadline, helping to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings and hearing arrangements
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Assisted with matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the deadline, translating complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with Adobe's internal legal and compliance requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Client intake interviewing, evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking